

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ J 6

♥ K Q J 10 8 7 6

♦ 10 6 2

♣ 4

♠ A 9 2

♥ A 9 2

♦ K Q 4

♣ A Q 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 10 8 3

♥ 4

♦ J 8 7 3

♣ K 5 2

♠ 7 5 4

♥ 5 3

♦ A 9 5

♣ J 10 9 8 3

West

3♥

North

3NT

East

South

All Pass

3NT by North

This is confirmed by East's lead of the ♥4, with a doubleton he would have led a higher card. So there is no need to hold up. But . . . it couldn't hurt, could it?

Yes, it could hurt real bad! Suppose West has nothing in his hand but the ♥ K Q J 10 8 7 6 that you already know about. When you let his ♥10 win the first trick he will realize that his hand is dead. And he may be smart enough, (or lucky enough), to switch to a ♠.

The purpose of the hold-up play is to cut communications between the two defenders. So the general guideline is to hold up until you are sure one of the defenders is void in the suit - maybe twice, maybe only once, and in this case not at all.

But one of the important considerations you have to think about is the possibility that the Defense will switch to another suit - where you might be in even more trouble.

You'd feel bad on this hand if you let West hold the ♥10 only to see him next lay down the ♠J.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥4. West plays the ♥10.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=3 ♣=1 Total = 6

You may not agree with North's 3NT bid but how else are you going to get to the only game that has a chance of making?

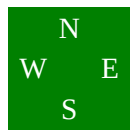
You need 3 extra winners and they will come from the ♣ suit even if East holds the ♣K and wins your finesse. You may think about holding up on the ♥A for one round just to make sure East has none if he wins the ♣K.

That would be a mistake. It is almost certain that West has a 7-card ♥ suit for his preemptive opening.

Board 3
East Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 3
♥ J 9 5 4
♦ 8 7 3
♣ Q 7 4 2

♠ Q 10 6 2
♥ K 7 6
♦ A Q J 9
♣ 9 5



♠ 4
♥ A Q 10 2
♦ K 6 4
♣ K 10 8 6 3

♠ A K J 8 7 5
♥ 8 3
♦ 10 5 2
♣ A J

West	North	East	South
		1♣	1♠
Pass	2♣	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South through dummy's ♥K. And the only card that West can get the lead with is the ♣Q.

Hold-ups are usually used in notrump hands, but here you use one to prevent the Danger Hand from gaining the lead. Let East have the ♣K. He cannot play a red card without helping you so he will surely play another ♣.

Pull trumps in two rounds. Then play the ♦10 and let it ride.

East will win this but he is helpless. Whatever he plays you will be able to discard a ♥ loser on dummy's ♦.

The purpose of the hold-up play is to cut communications between the two defenders. Here you knew you would lose exactly one ♣ trick so you chose to lose it to East, the Safe Hand.

If you had taken the first ♣ trick East would have won your later ♦ finesse, put his partner on lead with the ♣Q and then swallowed up your ♥K.

Of course if West had been clever enough to lead a ♥ originally this Deal wouldn't be here.

North's 2♣ cue-bid shows a limit-raise or better in ♠s. South is to play 4♠. West leads the ♣2. East plays the ♣K.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 4

You have one loser too many. If West holds either the ♥A or the ♦K this will be an easy contract, but East opened the bidding so he probably has most of the high cards. It does look like West holds the ♣Q based on his low lead and East's play to trick one.

Having gone through that thought process what is your Plan?

You will need to discard a loser on dummy's fourth ♦, but you must do so without ever letting West gain the lead since West is the defender who can lead

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 8 3

♥ Q J 10 6 4 2

♦ 7 3

♣ 4 2

♠ K J 7

♥ A 9 5

♦ J 10 9 2

♣ A K 10



♠ Q 10 6

♥ K 8

♦ K Q 6 5

♣ 8 7 5 3

♠ 9 5 4 2

♥ 7 3

♦ A 8 4

♣ Q J 9 6

West

2♥

All Pass

3NT by North

North

2NT

East

Pass

South

3NT

North's 2NT overcall shows a 1NT opening hand with ♥s stopped. North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥7. West plays the ♥10.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 4

You will need to establish both ♠ and ♦ winners. If West holds both these Aces along with 6 ♥s to the Q J then you are going down. But of course West can't have that good a hand, he opened with a Weak-2. So East has one of the Aces.

If you knew which Ace West held you could make sure you attacked that suit first but unfortunately you have no way of knowing that. So instead you resort to a hold-up. Let West have the first ♥ and win the next ♥ in dummy.

Start on ♦s next, maybe because they are longer. Assume that East holds the ♦A and takes it on the third round of the suit.

East glares at you, (because he has no ♥ to lead), and plays the ♣Q which you take with your ♣A. Next you score your ♦ winners and play a ♠, taken by West with the ♠A.

[showcards N:ST,S6,C8,C7 S:SK,SJ,CK,CT]

West glares at you, (because you still have the ♥A), and plays another ♥ to your Ace. You take your 3 tricks and let East have the last ♣.

If you did not hold up on the first trick, but established ♦s first you would not have made the contract.

If you did not hold up on the first trick, but established ♠s first you would have made the contract even though you played incorrectly.

If you held up on the first trick you made the contract no matter which Ace East held.